# Ali Marohomsalic Balindong

**Judge Ali Marohomsalic Balindong** is a Maranao lawyer, jurist, educator, and public servant from Lanao del Sur, known for his service across the judiciary, academia, and government in Mindanao.

He holds the traditional title of Sultan through the Royal House of Pagayawan, connecting his public career to a deep heritage of Maranao customary leadership and cultural identity.

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## EARLY LIFE AND EDUCATION

Judge Balindong comes from Lanao del Sur, one of the provinces at the heart of Maranao culture and the Bangsamoro homeland.

He pursued a career in law, establishing credentials as both a practitioner and an educator, and built a professional profile that spans the courtroom, the classroom, and the government service sector.

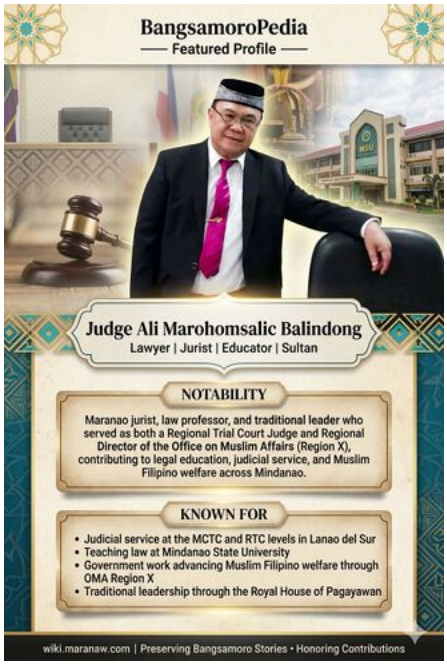
Specific details on his birth date, educational institutions, and bar admission year were not available in the submitted biography and could not be independently verified at the time of writing.

## LEGAL AND ACADEMIC CAREER

Judge Balindong served as a **Professor of Law at Mindanao State University (MSU)**, one of the premier state universities in Muslim Mindanao and a major center for legal education in the region.

His time at MSU gave him the platform to mentor students who would go on to careers in law, public service, and community leadership throughout Mindanao.

**Judge Ali Marohomsalic Balindong**




**Personal Information**

**Ethnicity:** Maranao
**Province:** Lanao del Sur
**Region:** Bangsamoro Autonomous Region in Muslim Mindanao (BARMM)

**Professional Roles**

Lawyer, Jurist, Educator, Government Official, Traditional Leader

**Judicial Positions Held**

Municipal Circuit Trial Court (MCTC) Judge
Regional Trial Court (RTC) Judge

He was a practitioner before the bench as well, building a reputation as a respected legal professional in Lanao del Sur before his appointment to the judiciary.

# JUDICIAL CAREER

Judge Balindong's judicial career began at the **Municipal Circuit Trial Court (MCTC)** level, where he presided over cases at the local level in Lanao del Sur.

He was subsequently appointed as a **Regional Trial Court (RTC) Judge**, a significant elevation that placed him among the senior members of the Philippine judiciary handling a wider and more complex docket.

His years on the bench were defined by a commitment to the fair administration of justice, with particular importance given the socio-political context of Lanao del Sur as part of the broader Bangsamoro region.

# GOVERNMENT SERVICE

Beyond the courts, Judge Balindong served as **Regional Director of Region X** under the **Office on Muslim Affairs (OMA)**, the national government agency responsible for Muslim Filipino welfare, representation, and development.

The OMA was later reorganized and transformed into the **National Commission on Muslim Filipinos (NCMF)** through Republic Act No. 9997, enacted in 2010.

In this executive role, he worked on programs aimed at the socio-economic advancement of Muslim communities, fostering cultural understanding and support for Muslim Filipinos within the framework of national governance.

It is worth noting that Region X (Northern Mindanao) and the predominantly Muslim Lanao del Sur are geographically adjacent, and regional OMA/NCMF offices served Muslim communities across regional boundaries.

# TRADITIONAL LEADERSHIP

Judge Balindong carries the title of **Sultan** through the **Royal House of Pagayawan**, one of the recognized royal houses of the Maranao people under the traditional governance structure of Lanao.

Lanao del Sur

**Academic Affiliation**

Professor of Law, Mindanao State University (MSU)

**Government Service**

Regional Director, Region X
Office on Muslim Affairs (OMA) / National Commission on Muslim Filipinos (NCMF)

**Traditional Title**

Sultan, Royal House of Pagayawan

**Notability**

Maranao jurist, law professor, and traditional leader who served as both a Regional Trial Court Judge and Regional Director of the Office on Muslim Affairs (Region X), contributing to legal education, judicial service, and Muslim Filipino welfare across Mindanao.

**Known For**

Judicial service at the MCTC and RTC levels in Lanao del Sur; teaching law at Mindanao State University; government work advancing Muslim Filipino welfare through OMA/NCMF Region X; and traditional leadership through the Royal House of Pagayawan.

The Pagayawan sultanate is part of the broader Taritib and Igma (customary law and code of conduct) of the Maranao, which organizes the four major confederations (*Pat a Pangampong a Ranao*) and their corresponding royal houses.

His dual identity as a career public servant and a traditional leader is, in many ways, a reflection of how many Maranao leaders navigate modernity without abandoning their roots.

# LEGACY AND CONTRIBUTIONS

Judge Balindong's legacy sits at the crossroads of law, education, public service, and tradition.

As a judge, he upheld rule of law in one of the country's most complex legal environments. As a law professor at MSU, he contributed to building the next generation of Mindanao lawyers. As a government official, he worked for the welfare of Muslim Filipinos through national institutions. And as a Sultan, he remained connected to the cultural foundation that gives meaning to all of that work.

His career is a useful reference point for understanding how Muslim Filipino professionals have engaged with Philippine national institutions while remaining rooted in Bangsamoro identity and heritage.

# SEE ALSO

- Mindanao State University
- Office on Muslim Affairs
- National Commission on Muslim Filipinos
- Royal House of Pagayawan
- Maranao people
- Lanao del Sur
- Bangsamoro Autonomous Region in Muslim Mindanao

1. Submitted biography of Judge Ali Marohomsalic Balindong (primary source, BangsamoroPedia editorial files).

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